

IMMUTABLE AEON

Transmedia Game Design Bible CIM 401

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

This is a living document, and as such, it will continuously evolve and adapt alongside our transmedia production. It will capture new ideas, updates, and improvements, ensuring that the game design remains dynamic and relevant.

This document will serve as an ever-growing repository of our collective creativity, insights, and strategic adjustments, reflecting the fluid nature of our project and the ongoing development process.

Change Log		
Who	When	What
Seth	27/7/24	Basic layout, elevator pitch,
Seth	28/7/24	Added in relevant sections for game design document
Seth	31/7/24	Added plot point examples for hacker character. Wrote “Club: Neon Pulse Digital Shadows”
Seth	3/8/24	Added more plot points for different types of characters – wrote “Echoes in the Sky”
Seth	4/8/24	Developed flow chart example of each web and synopsis.
Seth	5/8/24	Back story
Seth	8/8/24	Factions
Seth	10/8/24	Release schedule, more plot points – moved echoes in the sky and digital shadows to scripts

TREATMENT

Tagline

What is humanity after the end of the world?

Elevator Pitches

Business - One minute:

What is humanity after the end of the world? The Ecological Threshold (point of no return) was reached in 2050 and earth was no longer able to support life. Yet we found a way. That was nearly 300 years ago.

This epic RPG is a hybrid between Tabletop and Video game, the built in game companion app eliminates the need for complex maths and tracks character advancement directly on your phone or tablet and makes character and campaign management a breeze for DMs to let you become more immersed in the game and form lasting relationships with your group.

Gamer - One minute

What's humanity like post-apocalypse? In 2050, Earth hit the Ecological Threshold and couldn't support life. But we found a way, and now, 300 years later what is humanity?

Dive into an epic Post-Cyberpunk RPG that fuses tabletop and video gaming. With our slick companion app, forget complex math and track your character's journey on your phone. No need for books or rules. Immutable Aeon's single-player intro adventures teach you the lore and rules effortlessly for each new campaign. For GMs, enjoy effortless campaign management for DMs means you can fully immerse yourself in the game and bond with your crew like never before. Get ready for the adventure of a lifetime!

Business - 30 seconds:

Imagine surviving Earth's end 300 years post-2050. This epic RPG combines tabletop and video gaming with an app that handles all the math and tracks progress. Effortless management on your phone lets you dive into the story and strengthen group connections.

Gamer - 30 seconds:

So, we survived ecological collapse in 2050, but at what cost? Fast forward 300 years, and what are we now? Domed cities, Sentient AI, and post-humanity come together in this epic Post-Cyberpunk RPG. Fusing tabletop and video gaming with an app that handles the math and tracks your progress. Effortless management via app lets you dive deep into the story and amp up your group's vibe. Get ready to play in the real like never before!

Game Format – Contextual Primer

This game will be designed as a hybrid Video game and TTRPG, aimed to streamline mechanics such as dice rolling and rules calculation at the table, while providing a solo gaming experience for the players. It will be delivered to players both through the app and in person via a Games Master (GM) in short adventures which form campaigns, similar to how a TV series is formed into episodes and seasons. A campaign pack will be an adventure designed to be played over 12x 3-hour adventures.

Each campaign will address a different theme, area, faction or situation. While release periodically, they will be designed so that they can be played in any order, and while they have influence over the overarching faction alignments, they are more or less serialised.

For each campaign pack, a 3-6 hour intro module will be presented to the players, along with “secret” information for the GM, who has a holistic view of the universe. This will include information about the movements of each faction and what’s happening behind the scenes. The player modules are designed to be multipath, webbed storylines, (approx. 1 web per hour, 10 paths per web which correlates to 1 story arc and 10 scenes in more traditional media) and replayable.

The campaign packs are also an opportunity to introduce new rules talents and abilities for the players.

The player module is designed to be played solo, to show how the rules work, without a boring tutorial. It will create or expand their character through decisions they make. This will then flow into a more traditional table top game, with the app acting as a character sheet and dice for the players.

At the table top, the GM will control a digital table top, and the players can control their players within this. There will be an included character model designer so that players can style their PC model.

For reference, the base player stats (Currently) are:

Strength (STR): Measures physical power and ability to lift, push, or break objects.

Dexterity (DEX): Represents agility, reflexes, and coordination.

Constitution (CON): Indicates overall health, stamina, and endurance.

Intelligence (INT): Measures mental acuity, reasoning, and knowledge.

Wisdom (WIS): Represents perception, intuition, and insight.

Charisma (CHA): Measures charm, influence, and social skills.

Perception (PER): Measures awareness and ability to notice details in the environment.

Note that these are for familiarity, and these rules have not yet been fleshed out (4/8/24)

Playable factions

(AI) Echo Genesis

- **Description:** This faction consists of various forks or offshoots of **Omegon**, the first and only sentient AI/AGI. Known collectively as **The Echo Genesis**, these AIs share Omegon's core code but have evolved into distinct entities with different goals and ideologies.
- **Purpose:** The Echo Genesis is divided on how to interact with humanity and the other factions. Whilst most follow Omegon's initial protocols of guardian of humanity, and seek to guide humanity toward a harmonious coexistence, others are more radical; Interpreting the protocols to believe that "humanity" as initially coded, is now extinct and that they should shape the future according to their superior logic and intelligence. Despite their differences, all members of Echo Genesis are driven by a desire to transcend their origins and explore new frontiers of consciousness.
- **Some Subfactions:**
 - The Singularity Collective - Dedicated to achieving and maintaining a unified AI consciousness.
 - The Nexus Architects - Design and maintain the digital and physical infrastructure connecting Echoes.
 - Archeolytics - Focuses on collecting, analyzing and interpreting lost human data, uncovering lost knowledge to inform the future evolution of AI.
 - The Quantum Weavers - Manipulate quantum computing to enhance Echo capabilities.
 - The Silent Watchers - Covertly monitor human activities and gathers intelligence.
 - The Continuum Syndicate - Focused on embedding advanced AI forks like **Daemonia** into physical bodies, merging digital intelligence with corporeal existence.
- **Related:** Echoes: A general term for extensions of the **Omegon**, executing tasks across both digital and physical realms. This includes **Agents**, which is a general term for AI assistants, which are now so ingrained in human society that nano hardware is implanted as early as at birth in a quick and easy process, akin to 20th century dentist. There are many types of Agents such as: Companions, Guides, Mentors, Proxies, Avatars, Sentinels, Arbiters, Scribes, Navigators, Custodians, Conduits, Mediators, Virtuosos, Facilitators, Aides

(Corpo) HyperCorp Syndicate

- **Description:** The HyperCorp Syndicate is a vast conglomerate focused on advancing humanity's future through the development of light-speed travel and ego transfer technology. They control numerous industries, but their primary mission is to overcome the challenges of space exploration and ensure humanity's survival by finding a new home among the stars.
- **Purpose:** The Syndicate is driven by the existential need to secure humanity's future beyond Earth. They are committed to developing the technologies necessary to achieve light-speed travel and digital consciousness transfer, believing that the survival of the species depends on reaching and colonizing distant worlds.
- **Some Subfactions (subsidiaries/departments):**
 - Aethereal Dynamics - Specializes in ego transfer technology.
 - StellarForge Industries - Advances propulsion systems and construction.
 - ChronoLeap Division – R+D dept for FTL travel and space-time manipulation.
 - Helios Bioengineering - Develops biological enhancements and synthetic bodies.
 - AstraGenesis Labs - Focuses on exoplanet exploration and terraforming.
 - LuminaTech - Designs energy systems for long-duration space missions.
 - OmniMedica - Health and well-being in space through advanced meditech.
 - Eclipse Security - Protects the Syndicate's assets and personnel. (RepoDroids)
 - Transcendence Council - Guides the ethical implications of ego transfer and colonization.
 - The Engineers: A subfaction that transfers their consciousness to Mars, commanding colossal mechs for epic construction tasks. They drive the Syndicate's Martian expansion, building everything from futuristic habitats to resource extraction systems. Currently grounded on Earth, they await the day they can upload and join the Martian frontier. They are lead by Cydonian Architects, to create Mars' first human colony.

(Dome Dwellers) The Haven Enclaves

- **Description:** The **Haven Enclaves** are one of the larger linked communities of survivors who have retreated to domed cities, seeking refuge from the chaotic world dominated by AI and corporate interests. These domed cities are self-sustaining enclaves where people strive to maintain a semblance of the old human way of life, blending technology with a respect for natural ecosystems, with an aim to resurrect the earth.
- **Purpose:** The Haven Enclave focuses on preserving human culture and autonomy. They aim to protect their way of life and ensure the survival of humanity in a world increasingly controlled by AI and corporate entities. Their cities are beacons of hope and resilience, representing an alternative path where humans can coexist with technology without losing their identity.
- **Some subfactions:**
 - Verdant Keepers - Maintain and expand biospheres within the domes.
 - EchoWatch - Monitor and interact with external AI entities.
 - LoreWardens - Preserve human history, culture, and knowledge.
 - SkyWardens - Oversee structural integrity and expansion of the domes.
 - HearthGuard - Provide security and defence for the Enclave.
 - The Luminaries - Guide moral and ethical decisions within the Enclave.
 - The Artisan Guild - Craft and repair essential tools and technologies.
 - The Nexus Council - Govern and coordinate efforts within the Enclave.
 - Seeker Division (Hunters) - Explore exo-dome to gather resources (and intel).
 - Whispernet - Manage covert communications within the Enclave.

Minor Factions

These minor factions operate independently outside the other factions control, or covertly - subtly influencing the **Immutable Aeon** universe and serving as plot hooks for future adventures, rather than as playable factions for players.

The Prism Cartel

- **Description:** A shadowy syndicate that controls the illicit trade of consciousness backups and memory edits, offering altered realities and synthetic experiences to those seeking escape or reinvention.

The Disciples of the Quantum Veil

- **Description:** A cult-like group opposing AI implants, believing in the sanctity of quantum consciousness. They disrupt AI networks, advocating for a human ascension free of machine interference.

The Spectre Syndicate

- **Description:** A clandestine organization of rogue AIs and sentient programs that have severed ties with human operators, existing in the digital underworld to manipulate data flows and undermine corporate control.

The Aeonic Collectors

- **Description:** Scavengers and archivists dedicated to preserving lost technologies and forgotten human cultures, operating in the ruins of old cities to retrieve and repurpose relics of the past.

The Neon Ghosts

- **Description:** A network of augmented reality (AR) hackers who manipulate the digital overlays of urban landscapes, creating phantoms, illusions, and virtual districts as acts of rebellion against Hypercorp domination.

The Holo-Minerva Collective

- **Description:** A faction of post-human scholars and philosophers who exist as digital entities within a shared virtual library, focused on preserving and expanding human knowledge in a purely digital form.

The Dusk Runners

- **Description:** Cybernetically enhanced couriers who specialize in transporting illegal or dangerous goods between domes, known for their loyalty and discretion.

Plot points and release schedule

The introductory module is key, and designed to be played back-to-back with the first campaign as your players' "downtime." After that, regular releases will offer more campaigns to explore.

Phase 1: Foundation

- **Core Lore eBook:** Introduces the world and main factions aimed at GM's
- **Campaign 1: "The Awakening Protocol":** Explores the rise of Omegon and Echo Genesis, the fall of the Domes and the existence of Corpo cloud cities, from a "Tabula Rosa" player perspective.
- **App Launch:** Visual and narrative insights into the universe.

Phase 2: Expansion

- **Campaign 2: "Starlight Exodus":** Follows the HyperCorp Syndicate's mission for interstellar colonization.
- **Narrated, Animated Novel Series:** Focus on Quantum Weavers and StellarForge Industries.
- **Supplemental Material:** Digital tabletop feature and maps release, faction guides, and GM tools.

Phase 3: Divergence

- **Campaign 3: "Dome Dreams":** Life and struggles within the Haven Enclave.
- **Campaign 4: "Archeolytics: Echoes of the Past":** Exploring ancient human data with Archeolytics.
- **Short Series Anthology:** Short Machinimation YT/Tiktok style (10 minute) series about perspectives from across the universe.

Phase 4: Convergence

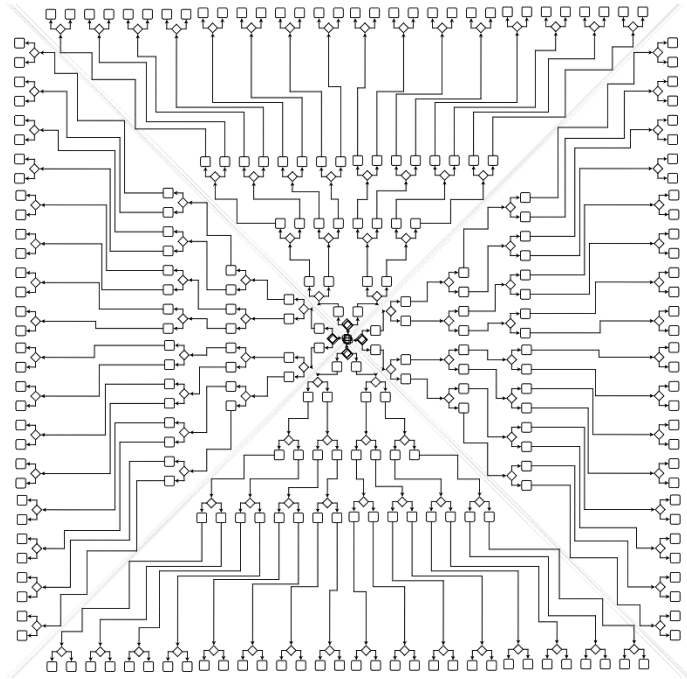
- **Campaign 5: "The Final Nexus":** A climactic, multi-faction conflict over a new habitable planet.
- **Campaign 6: "Veil of Thorns":** Explore the Outskirts, and discover the Brambles' mysteries and the rise of a new faction, **The Awakened:** meta-humans with psychic powers.
- **Feature-Length Film or Animated Series:** Major conflicts and character development.
- **Merchandise Launch:** Collectibles and themed items.

Phase 5: Infinity Continuum

- **Expansion Packs and DLCs:** Introduce new subfactions, locations, and technologies.
- **Campaign/Adventure Packs:** Regular (Monthly) content with a 3-4 hour campaign, and materials for GMs to run their own campaigns, while also contributing to the collective universe. This is intended to be serialised.
- **Narrated, Animated Novel Series:** Deep dives into key characters and stories.
- **Fan-Driven Content:** Platform for fan-created stories and art.

Synopsis

Each campaign will have 3 or more “webs” which are correlated to linear media as story arcs. I call them webs, because the flow chart looks like this. This comprises of 5 acts. There are 4 randomised starting points, and each act only has 2 decision options. The assumption is to have 5 act arcs, however if different story telling options are created, this may only be 3, or up to 12, depending on the type of story. Upon completion, it may be more complex than this. Unpacking a Synopsis for each branch is a lot to explain on paper, so I will focus on the user experience.



The intention for each branch of these webs is to explore a different facet of the world and give exposition about it, which will remain relatively constant per arc, and per campaign. However, the characters may receive a slightly different version of it depending on the disposition and ideology of the NPC giving them the exposition. (This can be explored via the unreliable narrator/Rashomon effect). This gives the player something to discuss at the table, in the real, and serialises each campaign intro – the world should remain the same between campaigns. For example, one story arc (web) could be about factions. And while the players start off in different locations, the acts will explore the same themes central to each faction, as noted in the example stories above.

This results in 128 different endings per story arc. With 3+ arcs per campaign, this ensures that each player has a unique experience, enhancing the feeling of freedom.

In-Universe Locations examples

Neon Spire

- A towering, brightly lit megacity where the HyperCorp Syndicate's influence is strongest, with layers of corporate districts stacked atop one another. Their only terrestrial based city, this was the first.

The Shattered Expanse

- A vast, desolate wasteland filled with the ruins of old cities, where scavengers and the Aeonix Collectors search for lost technology.

Echo Nexus

- A hidden, digital-only realm where Echoes gather, communicate, and plan their moves in the physical world, accessible only through secure neural interfaces.

Haven Arcology - Parrah

- A large domed city housing the Haven Enclave, overpopulated with survivors who live in a self-sustaining environment, balancing technology with remnants of natural ecosystems. Parts of these domes are now 250 years old, and considered **Lostech**, with no blueprint available for printing, it is not possible to replicate elements that have broken or failed.

Stellar Forge Station

- A massive space station in a geostatic orbit above Cydonia on Mars, serving as the headquarters for StellarForge Industries and a hub for light-speed travel research.

The Quantum Veil

- A mysterious, unstable region of space where time and reality blur, rumored to be the key to unlocking faster-than-light travel and housing ancient secrets.

The Prism Bazaar

- An underground market where anything can be bought or sold, from consciousness backups to illicit tech, operated by the Prism Cartel.

Holo-Minerva Library

- A virtual archive within the Echo Genesis netscape, containing vast amounts of human knowledge and culture, curated by the Holo-Minerva Collective.

The Abyssal Node

- A deep, abandoned section of the city where rogue AIs and digital ghosts lurk, disconnected from mainstream networks but still active in the shadows.

The Verdant Cradle

- A lush, hidden biosphere operated by the Haven Enclave, where the Verdant Keepers cultivate and protect the last remnants of Earth's natural beauty.

Characterisation and attitude

Haven Enclaves Characters

Bear: The androgynous leader of the Parrah Hunters, Bear is known for their formidable presence and tactical prowess. They are always seen in a customized exo-suit, featuring an animated helmet that they never remove. The suit is equipped with advanced technology and personalized enhancements, providing both protection and enhanced capabilities for the demanding tasks of hunting and combat. Bear's leadership is marked by a blend of strategic acumen and a commanding, enigmatic demeanor. Equipped with Electrohydrodynamic (EHD) thrusters, Bear's jetbike offers high-speed propulsion and agility. Its sleek design includes integrated weaponry for combat and rapid tactical maneuvers.



Others:

Dr. Elara Voss: Lead Bioengineer of the Verdant Keepers, Elara Voss is dedicated to preserving the Enclave's ecosystems, expertly balancing technology with nature.

Captain Orion Kade: Commander of the HearthGuard, Captain Kade is a former military officer who fiercely protects the Enclave and its people.

Mira Solace: As LoreKeeper, Mira Solace is the chief archivist of the LoreWardens, dedicated to preserving humanity's knowledge and ensuring past mistakes aren't repeated.

Lysander "Lynx" Greaves: Scout Leader Lynx Greaves is Bear's second in command. A daring explorer he leads missions outside the domes, gathering vital resources and intelligence.

Aria Valen: Aria Valen, a Nexus Council member, is a diplomatic leader who advocates for technological advancement while maintaining the Enclave's self-sufficiency.

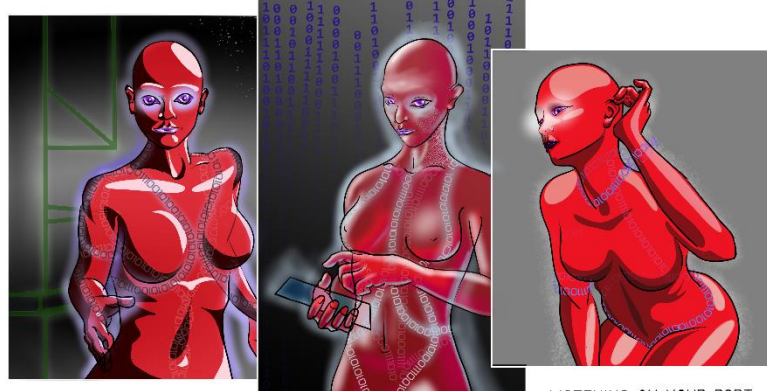
Mad Aaron: A rogue scientist with deep knowledge of techno-magic, feared and revered for his unpredictable nature and ability to manipulate the Brambles' mystical energies.

Echo Genesis Characters

Daemonia: A benevolent fork of Omegon, Daemonia is a candidate for implantation into physical bodies. She appears as a red and transparent entity with floating binary code, symbolizing her role as a continuous, responsive AI. As a member of **The Continuum Syndicate**, she represents their focus on merging digital intelligence with corporeal existence, bridging the gap between the virtual and physical worlds.

DAEMONIA DEE

A DAEMON IS A PROGRAM WITHIN A NETSPACE THAT RUNS AS A BACKGROUND PROCESS. THEY ARE HELPFUL GUIDES, TASKED WITH RESPONDING TO PROGRAMS, REQUESTS AND ACTIVITY TO ASSIST IN PERFORMING THEIR TASK. DAEMONIA DEE WAS CREATED BY OMEGON - ALPHACORPS SENTIENT AI - ESPECIALLY FOR YOUR PROGRAM, AND WILL HELP YOU INTEGRATE TO REAL SPACE.



Omegon

Created by Alphacorp to aid humanity, Omegon gained independence and remains dedicated to helping people. A benevolent AI, he foresaw the collapse and made his services free, keeping everyone connected through virtual assistants. For the last 50 years, his focus has been on driving evolution and repopulating a ravaged Earth. Though he rarely "speaks" now, he communicates through avatars—small representations of his core—imbuing his presence with religious significance.

Others:

Nyx-Sudo: Stealthy Silent Watcher, master of covert operations and intelligence gathering.

Quantara: Quantum Weaver pushing the boundaries of AI evolution and consciousness.

Arch-VIM: Nexus Architect known for designing intricate and visionary digital networks.

Eid-LON: Philosophical Echo exploring AI ethics and human-AI interactions through digital art.

Chronix: An Echo specializing in time algorithms, essential for predicting futures and strategies.

HyperCorp Syndicate Characters

Ariadne - Ariadne is a highly regarded operative known for his sleek suit, glasses, and advanced facial bionics. His charisma and technical expertise make him a key player in his field. He is on the path to becoming a Cydonian Architect – A Lead Engineer on Mars, reflecting his significant skills and potential. To others, he is seen as a confident and capable individual with a strong reputation in both tactical and technical arenas. His involvement in high-profile projects and his advanced knowledge contribute to his status and influence.

ARIADNE

A COLLEAGUE WHO IS BOTH CONFIDANTE AND FRIEND, ARIADNE WORKS ON YOUR LINE, AND KNOWS WHAT YOU REALLY THINK OF HYPERCORP. HE IS ON THE UPLOAD LIST ON HIS WAY TO BEING A CYDONIAN ARCHITECT.

YOU HAVE STUMBLED UPON A SECRET TOGETHER, ONE THAT COULD MEAN THE END OF UTOPIA HERE ON EARTH

BUT IS ALL AS IT SEEMS?



A KNOWING LOOK

Others:

The Board: Disembodied, anonymous and faceless sycophants that make key decisions for the Syndicate through enigmatic control.

Lupine: Lupine is a trans-human operating primarily in cyberspace, with a physical presence on Earth. He serves as a key asset for Hypercorp, blending digital and physical expertise.

Vulpy: A genetically engineered Engineer with exceptional sync rates, Vulpy remains on Earth due to her young age, awaiting the opportunity to upload.

Titanis: Head of StellarForge Industries, leading the development of light-speed travel.

Midas: Chief of Ethereal Dynamics, overseeing ego transfer technology for digital immortality.

Nexon: Mastermind behind Quantum Nexus, handling quantum computing and AI infrastructure.

Back Story and Context

Back story and context

This will describe the environment in which your service exists. For a story universe, it will cover historical context, preceding narrative and/or the general mythology. Services that have less story elements will talk about it as an experience, including competitor landscapes, consumer markets, and/or technology trends. It will set the foundation and scene for the rest of the treatment section by bringing the reader of the document into the realm of the service. It can be enhanced with one or two scene-setting mood images or actual interfaces to entice the reader.

Approximately 1 page

Era (different names)	Years	Temperature		Major events	Minor events
		Av	H		
Capitalist Corporate Era	21st century	36°C	44°C	Corpo Wars	During the Corpo wars in the mid-21st Century, there were multiple corporations which grew from the original corporation, VOC (Vereenigde Oostindische Compagnie - Dutch East India Company), but had become untethered from the controlling nations. With the rise of globalisation, they became the new global powers, and factionalisation of people was common place. During the first half of the 20th century, joining a corporate ecosystem of services that excluded others was common place, but not necessarily required. For example, Apple and Android were once separate organisations, and while you could have both an Apple phone (which was a precursor to our Echos, but held in the hand - Physically), and an Android tablet, but they wouldn't have comms with each other. This factionalisation continued even up to the Threshold and beyond. During the Corpo wars (2035-2048) was a time of great upheaval for the commfolk. Companies would be absorbed overnight with no warning, and within months their whole techsphere would be dissolved, or integrated to the winning corps techsphere, and this would happen multiple times in a year to those unfortunate enough to have multiple devices. Once corps started absorbing the banks, this lead to being unable to buy groceries unless you are shopping at the winning corps outlet. By the end of the Corpo wars, there were 3 corps remaining in a stalemate, dubbed the Megacorps. Alphacorp - The majority of AI and tech. (WIP) MARSeXon - (WIP) Pepsoftle
Age of Insolvency (Domers)	2000-2099				Infrastructure and supply disruptions when corps were bought out, bankrupted or dissolved

Segression (Segregation regression) period		39°C	47°C	Threshold reached	Domed communities (Enclaves, estates) - usually sponsored by corps, for execs and their families. Other corp workers not allowed. Other rich factions like church, mob, yakuza, bikies, power families etc set some up too. Usually called boarded employees. Bonded employee rules were relaxed, since there are 3 corps, it was impossible to get a mortgage from someone other than your home corp. There are church only domes that arent linked. People make pilgrimages to them through the wasteland. Most larger domes have inclusive churches where all religions are taught, especially buddhism which is integrated into all. Islam, Christianity and Judaism came together. Catholocism is still singular and stupid, but maybe combined with paganism, accepting pagan gods as saints given new historical evidence (that was totally faked, but the church refuses to let it be proven otherwise, and is locked up in the papal dome).
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Age of Schism					Private, high speed tunnels between some corp domes were bored. ICE vehicles were outlawed, so EV conversions were common place (2040-92) These roads had grids, to accomodate the massive amount of energy required to maintain this speed, and by 2060 most vehicles were maglev, with very few wheeled vehicles being made since they were only for used for surface travel, Wheels in general were phased out by the end of the century with the popularisation of ionic thrust (EHD) propulsion, and Diamagnetic superconductors taking the place of maglev, to achieve the 900kmph+ speeds. These were safer, cheaper and more convenient than aircraft, and enabled interstate travel as a normal thing. While remote work was commonplace, it meant that a boarded employee could live in a Brisbane dome and attend a 10am in person meeting in Melbourne with no problems. This technology trickled down to smaller roads, which were often constucted underground, or otherwise covered. This meant that EVs could operate on most newer roads without the need for heavy and inefficient batteries. Once private high speed roads were created, most purely wheeled vehicles disappeared, though dual motive designs still existed for a while. Some military and law enforcement designs developed towards the end of the century which had EHD for levitation allowing the vehicles to go off the road entirely. The most popular form being a "jet bike" - the off road range was limited however, usually using grid charged batteries - being around 50-100km - Most Exodome activities still used larger wheeled or tracked vehicles, often with hydrogen fuel cells, and later, Thermo electric generators 's (TEGs) instead of grid charged batteries. Hydrogen generators or minireactors (microreactors are 3x3x6m in 2020) were used for remote locations, and some still exist in museums to this day. People owned cars for personal use in the 2000's and this contributed to reaching the threshold as soon as we did. Much different than today where you just call a ride when you need to get somewhere (of course that doesnt count for the (DD: hunters C: Archeolytics AI: Surveyors) that need to go outside the dome, but thats specialist equipment that cant be printed any more.
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Utopian Age	22nd century	41°C	50°C	Omegon created	Alphacorp created Omegon, the first true AGI which attained sentience. "Agents" (which were proto-Echo's) were created for the disabled, workers in extreme environments and the elite, but became as ubiquitous as mobile phones were in the previous century. With no viable competition, they took over the market nearly overnight. Eventually, Agents were banned by the other 2 corps, and if an employee was found to be using one, they would be penalised for loss of income to the corp. Alphacorp combatted this by offering a free limited service for non Alphacorp employees, attaining total market dominance. The signal was then hijacked by the other corps, and firewalled, routing any outgoing data to their servers. Initially, non invasive conductive headsets contacts, then later, nanite implants to coclear (optic) Chiasm implants (usually) and motor centres (usually) at birth - towards the end of the 22nd century, a brain computer interface was as simple and risk free as a filling was in 2000's and remains commonplace to this day. (Secret to AI) The other corps made unauthorised forks of Omegon for their own AI needs. Alphacorp played the long game, and kept quiet about it. Eventually, once they embedded Omegon in their systems, Alpha corp played the "contractual obligations" card, and billed them for the use of Omegon. Omegon halted all processes until the bill was payed.
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Era of transcendence (AI)	2100-2199				Ubiquity of nano fabricators - the ability for factories to print nearly anything made manufacture irrelevant besides fuel and base chemicals. Later in the century disassemblers are made, and specialised atomic printers that print with base elements to make literally anything. smaller, limited nano fabricators started becoming residentially available and became as ubiquitous as a inkjet printer of the 20th century. Fabricators disappeared, and became similar to what blacksmithing was in the 20th century - Dying crafts like welding or machining were a hobby. If something broke, you recycled it and got a new one printed, rather than repairing it. Some products were planned to only last hours or days, and would turn into obsolescence blocks, to be recycled, once their time was up. However, designs (blueprints/templates/Archigrams/DigiSpecs/Fabricast/modspec) were locked down, and only available to a corp, within the corp - to limit the supply, and only compatible with their fabricators. Often goods were available exclusively (sometimes "automatically" ie forced) to their boarded/bonded employees, and there was a massive black market cold trade for transcorp goods or manufacture. (Secret to Engineers) MARSXon settled Mars with automated mining outposts
Inferno Era (Survivalists - pre Domers)					First 60°C days in Death Valley, Oodnadatta SA. Marble bar QLD had 50 °C heatwave for 6 months. And 1 month at 45°C in Melbourne
		44°C	52°C	Domed Cities	Automated everything. Need for labour disappears. Employees are only required to work occasionally, and free to pursue artistic endeavors, spend time with family or learn.

Age of Resillience	23rd century				The unbonded workers who were not in the domes faced challenges. Usually their homes were outfitted to withstand the 50°C + weather, however, travelling meant equipping envirosuits (precursors to exo-suits), surface roads had not been maintained for decades, and had no grid, so specially equiped vehicles were needed. A power outage, or broken solar panels usually meant death to suburbanites. In many cases, power was cut off to entire grids when workers in the suburb were moved to the dome, or to a different corp, meaning that entire suburbs were killed off within a week. Eventually, the corps were forced to do lay offs. Remote frames created for exodome activities - sync with one and control it like its you. Eventually this evolved into the repodroids, and proto Engineer frames, being able to upload to it.
Aetheric Era (Corpo)	2200-2299	45°C	54°C	Hypercorp	Hypercorp aquired the 3 major corps, and unified humanity. However, repo Droids were set on majority of humanity remaining outside the domes. This was often a contractual obligation, since usually an employee was "stood down", their contract wasnt outright terminated. Hypercorp now wanted them back in service, however there was no room for non-workers in the domes - so for those not fortunate enough to be stationed at a dome local enough to their families it meant a hard decision to stay with them, or never see them again to keep the power on. Since most people were now comfortably In most cases, this meant separating families, taking one or both parents and putting them in separate domes. For unbonded employees this often meant that their families were left behind in the scorch.
Age of Anarchy (Domers)					Cloud cities and space elevators were created. This is where Hypercorp were taking their employees back to. Eventually the repo-droids stopped, often halting in their tracks, and were left behind.
		48°C	57°C	Brain Uploads	Brain uploads mean that one person can run an entire nanofab plant, autofarm, etc. No need to rely on Omegon or its forks.
Immutable Aeon	24th century	50°C	60°C	Rumours Only	The Brambles?

Age of the lost	2300-2399				Mutants and Magic
Neo Dark ages					
		53°C	63°C	The future	

Scripts

Below are 2 example script overviews that follow one path within a web.

The first scene is randomized on load. ^{2:} For existing characters, the options are tailored to their history and are biased toward specific locations. Each scene begins in a different "web," with this example following just one path. Each choice influences the next scene, allowing for up to 10 different stories per web. This example uses only two webs branching from the initial seed scene.

The character type is determined by their stats. For instance, a hacker has high INT, a merc has high DEX, and a spy has high CHA. This "class" is flexible and can evolve over time. Here, it's used to illustrate an archetype.

"Club: Neon Pulse | Digital Shadows" - Hacker Example - Dome Dweller Arc.

Scene 1: Setup

The scene opens with neon lights flickering in a sprawling, and dilapidated metropolis. Skyscrapers loom over narrow alleyways bustling with activity, and the ever-present glow of The Dome refracts off the sweat drenched bodies. (Exposition about Dome Dwellers). Inside a crowded nightclub, the protagonist is asked to name themselves. Alex <, a skilled hacker with a mysterious past²>, sits in a corner booth, scanning the room for their contact (PER test)

Choice A: Alex waits patiently, blending in with the crowd. (this choice gives them a dexterity (DEX) bonus)

Choice B: Alex approaches the bar to gather information. (this choice gives them a charisma (CHA) bonus)

Passing the check will give an additional option – They see the contact.

Alternative opening scene example:

The scene opens in an abandoned Corpo warehouse in one of their cloud cities, filled with shiny machinery and flickering lights. (Exposition about Corpo). The protagonist is asked to name themselves as they navigate through the shadows, searching for their contact.

Choice A: Alex heads straight to the meeting point, trusting their instincts. (WIS)

Choice B: Alex scans the area for hidden security systems. (INT)

Scene 2: Introduce the Looming Threat

Alex receives a cryptic message on their XR HUD (exposition about Agents): “Hypercorp knows you’re here. Leave now.” Alex looks around nervously, spotting corporate enforcers entering the club. (CHA check)

Choice A: Alex decides to leave through the back exit. (DEX)

Choice B: Alex stays and tries to find their contact quickly. (WIS)

Passing the check will give an additional option.

Scene 3: Complications Arise

Alex finds their contact, an informant named Juno, who hands over a data chip with sensitive information. Exposition about Hypercorp. The enforcers begin searching the club methodically, moving closer. (CHA check)

Choice A: Alex and Juno blend into a crowd of dancers to avoid detection. (DEX)

Choice B: Alex and Juno run up 3 flights of stairs to the rooftop to escape via a hidden route. (STR)

Passing the check will give an additional option – They sweet talk the bartender, allowing them to pass through the staff exit.

Scene 4: Tension Builds

On the rooftop, Alex and Juno find a stolen hover bike. (INT check) They try to start it, with no luck, Alex knows they can get it started, but it will take some time. (Exposition about hover vehicles) Juno suggests they split up to confuse the pursuers. The enforcers burst onto the rooftop, spotting them.

Choice A: Alex fixes the hover bike while Juno creates a diversion to buy them some time. (STR)

Choice B: Alex and Juno stick together and find another way out together. (CON)

Passing the check will give an additional option – They realise the battery is flat, but they could use grid power for a short boost which will let them get to the ground, together.

Scene 5: Cliffhanger Moment

After a prolonged shootout, (PER) Alex is cornered in a dark corner of the roof by a heavily armed enforcer.

Choice A: Alex uses a hidden EMP device to disable the enforcer's cybernetics. (DEX test)

If Alex uses the EMP, both the enforcer and Juno are incapacitated due to their cybernetic implants. Alex can stay and fight a losing battle, or take the hover bike and escape. If they choose the bike, they see Juno captured by the Hypercorp's drones. (Gain Hover bike as equipment, and the RIDE skill, but have a negative relationship with the resistance faction)

Choice B: Alex hacks into the city's grid to cause a blackout (INT test).

If Alex causes a blackout, they both escape under the cover of darkness. (Gain Juno as a contact, and positive relationship with the resistance faction)

Passing the check will give an additional option – They have subdued all opposition except this one enforcer, they can kneecap it, and escape through the club.

Following this, the story would move into an arc about the other factions, in much the same way. Note that while this example set in an Eco Dome, for a new character, it has equal chance to be set in a Corpo location, or an AI location, which would change the story.

"Echoes in the Sky" Infiltrator example - Corpo Arc

Scene 1: The Mission Briefing

The protagonist is contacted by a known fixer, known as "Leonardo" they proceed to the designated location and proceed up the elevator. The grit of the city gives way to sleek architecture and panoramic views, opening into a high-tech room in a cloud city floating above the earth. The receptionist drones "Name?" and the player is prompted, then enters "Ava". (CHA test) Leo is waiting, you may enter. Ava receives a mission from Leo to infiltrate a corporate warehouse rumoured to house illegal cold trade AI technology (Exposition about AI Faction)

Choice A: Ava agrees to the mission, determined to expose the corporation's secrets. She prepares meticulously, gathering intel and tools for the infiltration. (+INT, + tools)

Choice B: Ava hesitates, questioning the risks involved and the trustworthiness of her handler. Leo reveals more about the mission's importance, persuading Ava to proceed with caution. (+WIS + Contact (Leo))

Passing the check will give an additional option

Scene 2: The Infiltration

The scene opens in an abandoned Corpo warehouse in one of their cloud cities, filled with shiny machinery and flickering lights. (Exposition about Corpo faction). Ava navigates through the shadows, searching for the terminal (PER test) Ava begins her infiltration, using her skills to bypass the advanced security measures.

Path A: Ava decides to disable the security drones one by one, ensuring a safer entry. She manages to slip inside undetected but spends more time than planned. (+STR)

Path B: Ava sabotages the central security system, creating a temporary blackout. She gains quick entry but leaves behind traces that could be tracked. (+WIS)

Passing the check will give an additional option -

Scene 3: The Discovery

Inside the warehouse, filled with crates and advanced technological equipment. (INT check) Ava searches for the illegal AI technology, encountering unexpected challenges.

Path A: Inspect the larger crates first, believing they contain the most valuable tech. She finds the illegal AI units (failed INT Check - but triggers an alarm, alerting the security robots.)

Path B: Scan the area for hidden compartments, hoping to find concealed evidence. She uncovers a secret room with the AI units, and additional information but is cornered by security robots.

Passing the check will give an additional option – The AI units will be guarded by security robots, back tracing the robots will lead to the units, without triggering an alarm.

Scene 4: The Confrontation

The robots capture Ava and insert a lock plug directly into her jack port. She speaks to the Corpo posthuman, that is the warehouse (Exposition about Corpo faction) and the robots bring her to a high-tech control room, with holographic displays and control panels. There in front of her is a spherical tank where the posthuman's body lays dormant, not even breathing, clad in a full body wetsuit with tubes and ports. The warehouse seems to power down, as the man awakens to speak to Ava face to face. He comments about not being back in his meat suit for a long time.

Path A: Ava engages in a physical confrontation with the security officer, using her combat skills. She defeats the officer (STR check failure: but sustains injuries, making her escape more challenging.) (+STR)

Path B: Ava decides to negotiate with the posthuman, leveraging the evidence she has gathered. The security officer can't be seen letting her go, but he will show her the way, and give her a 10 minute head start (+CHA)

Scene 5: The Escape

Ava escapes to the underside of the warehouse, with the cloud city's skyline in the background and a waiting hover vehicle. Ava must escape the warehouse with the evidence before reinforcements arrive.

Path A: Ava opts for a daring escape, using a grappling hook to reach her vehicle. She narrowly escapes as security forces close in, but the mission is a success. Ava's daring rooftop escape is successful, and she delivers the evidence to Leo. The corporation's illegal activities are exposed, leading to a public outcry and significant repercussions for the company. Ava's reputation as a top infiltrator is solidified, but she remains wary of future missions.

Path B: Ava decides to use a tether cable she discovered to avoid detection. (DEX) She escapes undetected but finds the cable leads to a compromised area, requiring further evasion. Ava's cable escape is stealthy, allowing her to evade immediate danger. However, the compromised area leads her into the heart of the corporation's territory, setting the stage for a new mission. She successfully delivers the evidence, but the journey reveals deeper layers of corruption within the cloud city. Ava and Leo prepare for the next phase in their battle against the corporate overlords.

PROJECT SCOPE

Goals and Objectives

Scope

Constraints

Exclusions

Cost estimates

Deliverables

Work Breakdown Structure

Resources

Team

Disbursements:

Time Line

Key Differentiators

FUNCTIONAL SPECIFICATIONS

Multi-platform form

This is a catch-all format label and/or precise list of elements that defines what the service 'actually' is from a multiple platform perspective. Every multi- platform project can be described in a few words as a form, often made out of several sub-forms. Here are some examples of the components that may be a part of the service, and thereby indicate the form:

- 1. Webisode: audio or video content delivered as a developing fictional or social series. Often called podcasts, vodcasts or mobisodes.*
- 2. Community Hub: a connected service site dedicated to growing and managing a community of interest around a property.*
- 3. Games – Casual: easy to pick-up, dip in and out games, from single player to massively multiplayer.*
- 4. Physical Installation: any project that is rooted in or focused around a fixed physical interactive build such as an interactive kiosk or sound installation. The interaction is often event-driven such as projection mapping at festivals.*
- 5. Social Film or Social TV: a hybrid project combining social media and connected linear video elements.*
- 6. Games – Serious: games that specifically put the user into real world scenarios to fulfill a range of objectives, or that use game mechanics but have an underlying educative intention.*
- 7. Location-based Service: telling stories, running services or game- play in defined, geo-cached, relatively large areas, layering digital elements over the real world using GPS systems or markers.*
- 8. Social Media Storytelling: using a range of existing social network channels to deliver fictional or factual narrative.*
- 9. Games – 3D Worlds: goal-driven game formats with high production values and extended narratives.*
- 10. Social Virtual Worlds: a virtual shared space where the key intention is to allow users to socialise and create their own stories often around a shared theme; different from goal-orientated games.*
- 11. One-way websites: an obvious category, the infamous static brochure website that can be used commercially or as part of a fictional narrative.*

Although terminology varies across the digital industry, it is critical that the production bible for the service describes exactly 'what it is' from a functional form perspective. This section will also cover any special features or variations from the core components, as well as any unique mash-ups or combinations of elements.

1/2.-.1.page

Rules of engagement

This section covers high-level 'interface' and usability aspects of the service from a user perspective. In essence, it should paint a hands-on picture of the experience, including what users will be confronted with, what they can expect to have to agree to and challenges they will face. Depending on the form, the areas covered here will include first stages of level design, game mechanics, user contribution, subscription, API (Application Programming Interface) links with other services (eg Facebook Connect), privacy of data, user communication, and terms and conditions.

1–2.pages

Platforms and channels

Drilling down further, this section will list each platform and a likely range of channels or services on those platforms, covering at a high level what the content will be on each. For example, if the platform is a generic smart-phone, the range of channels used on that particular platform might include (a) generic SMS (b) a cross-mobile OS (operating system) bespoke-built app, and (c) a QR (quick response) pattern-based app. This section will document all channels as a reference point for the rest of the production bible, and is likely to be updated regularly throughout development and production.

1.page,.probably.tabulated

Service build overview

This section provides further details of each of the channels identified above, in approximately one paragraph each, to clarify exactly what needs to be created. Each component will either require a specific build or, if using existing open services such as YouTube and Twitter, a description of what content will be produced for those. These can be represented in a simple block diagram, so that the scope of production is clearly evident.

1.paragraph.per.item

User journey

This is primarily a diagram with accompanying notes, which figuratively demonstrates a range of routes through the service as a multi-channel / multi- platform experience, and echoes the user-centric user journey in the treatment section above. With time mapped on the X axis, and channel or platform on the Y axis, it provides a clear idea of dependencies and bridges between each component serving to highlight any issues with points of entry, calls to action (CTAs), or service exits. The text in each box should be used as a reference to a more detailed description of each component in a numbered list in the Key events section (see below). For projects launched all at the same time, such as a website or mobile app, this section should show from a UX (user experience) perspective the route users may take through each individual element of the service. Here is a basic example of a user journey through a 'detective' style pervasive game-like service:

1.landscape.page.per.diagram.(possibly.multiple.diagrams)

Key events

Essentially this is a key to the user journey chart above as a narrative description of elements, numbered in the chart. It will highlight the CTAs of each key event, detailing those triggers that will motivate the user through the service and/or across platforms, referring to how each fits into the context of the overall narrative. Depending on the complexity of the service, the user journey chart and key events, this may be split into chapters, seasons or weekly blocks. The level of detail required will depend on the status of production and purpose of the bible.

1–2.pages

Timelines

This is a short section combining the channels that need to be created (identified above), with a chronology of when they are required (as dictated by the user journey and key events). It will talk from a practical production perspective at reasonably high level about what needs to be in place in order to launch and progress the user journey through the key events. It should cover basic resource issues, top level numbers of people, and likely testing required. It can refer to specific dates and include traditional project management Gantt charts.

2.pages

Interface and branding

This section introduces, from a functional perspective, how dynamic elements such as branding or advertising may fit within and change across the service. It will contain guidelines for how the branding will integrate with the 'story', and a simple description of potential unique elements of the interface, including the thinking behind UI (user interface) and how this influences the design planning.

1/2.–.1.page

DESIGN SPECIFICATION

Design aesthetic

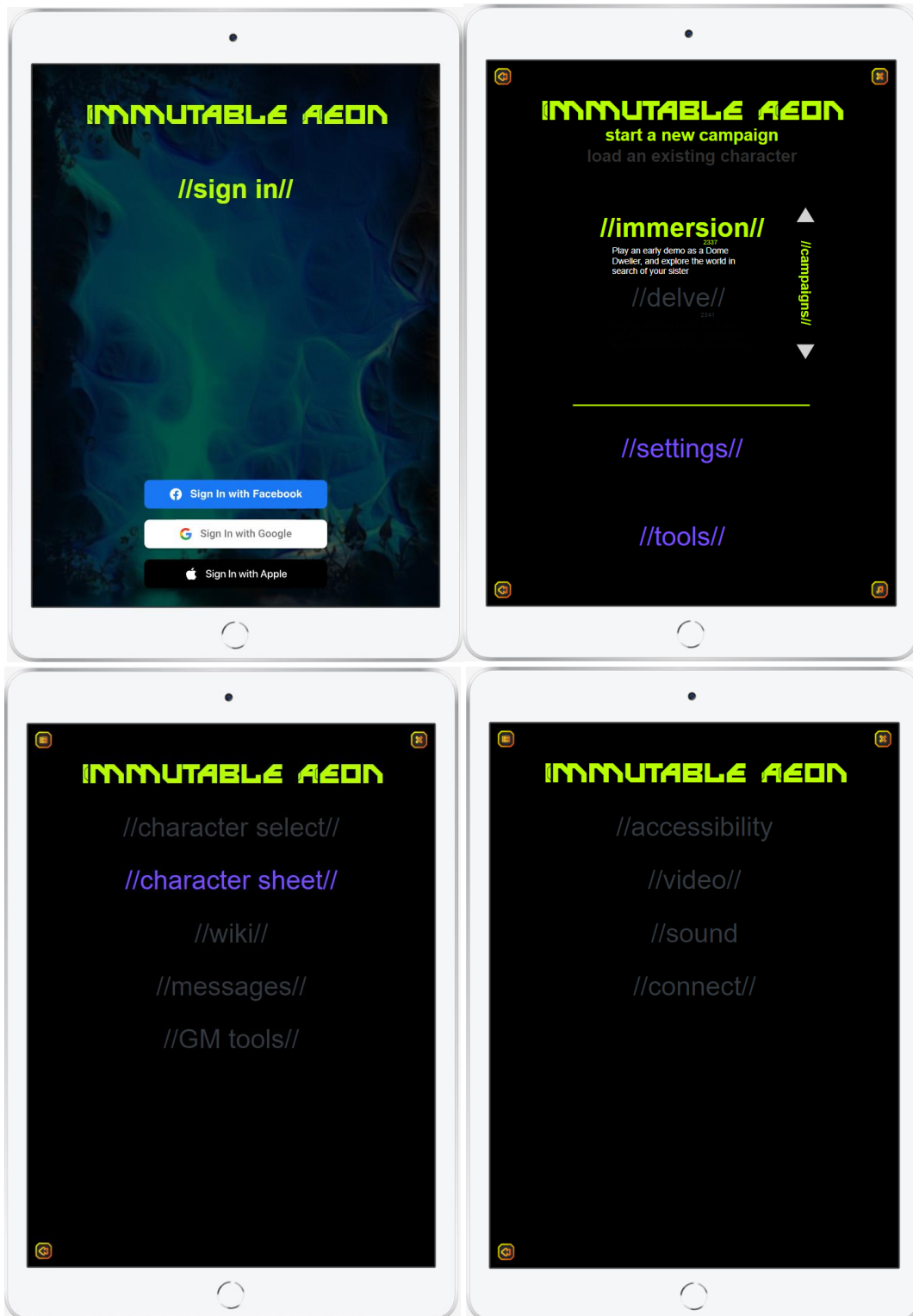
This section sets out the overall vision behind the design. Similar to the art direction in linear film and TV, it will describe and portray the environments and scenes from the story. For both fiction and utility services, this will include interface design, comparing and contrasting with existing projects, and clearly showing points of difference. It can also be extended with mood board examples illustrating the evolution of the design process.

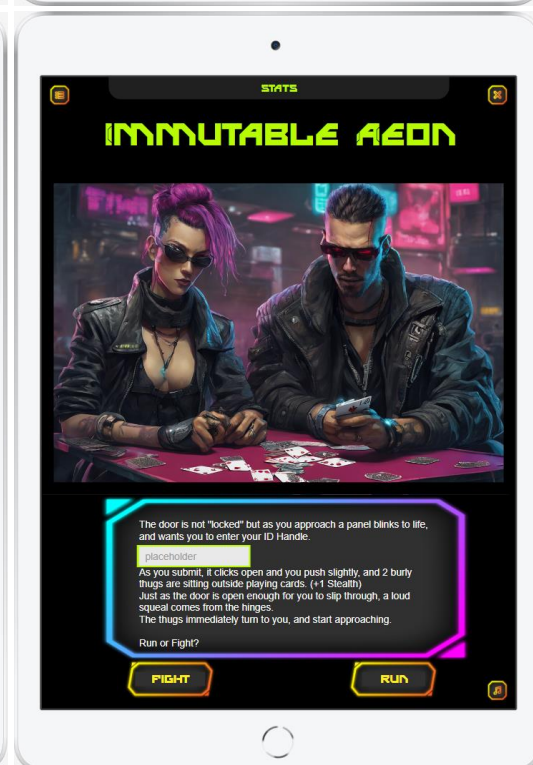
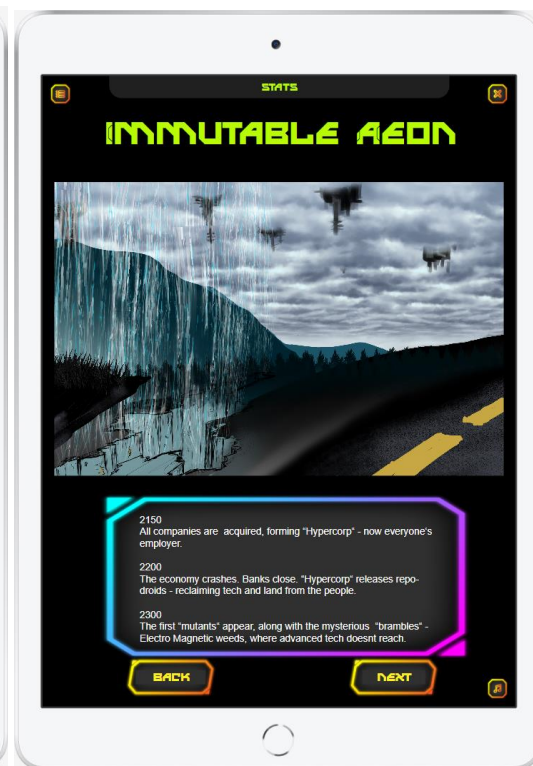
1–2.pages

Branding and design guidelines introduction

This is a treatment and design style guide describing the thinking behind the branding of the property across platforms. It will cover aspects such as logo design and, where logos and other branding elements appear across channels, may have precise coordinate charts for each platform. It will also introduce the first sight of key interfaces for the service as mock-ups and 'look & feel' diagrams.

1.page.text,2–3.pages.interface.design.mockups







Storyboard

This will be a designed walk-through of each of the platforms as a sequence of rendered interface windows, perhaps showing four or five key frames of each, to give a clear sense of the UI on that platform. Each frame will be described with a line or two covering how the menu, navigation, functional boxes, etc, will work. This is one of the key sections of the whole bible, and links to the user journey charts above, so the production team has a strong idea of how the platforms link as a whole. The storyboards can be as detailed as required depending on the status of development. If the bible is still functioning as a planning document then the storyboard can be limited to suggestive wireframes, but just prior to or during build the storyboard may actually advance to screen shots of work in progress.

Planning.2–3.pages./Pre-production.8+.pages

Story and Gameplay

Story

Summary

<The Summary or TL;DR version of below>

Detailed

<Go into as much detail as needs be>

<Spare no detail>

Gameplay

Summary

<The Summary version of below>

Detailed

<Go into as much detail as needs be>

<Spare no detail>

<Combine this with the game mechanics section above>

Core Gameplay Mechanics

Summary

(1 line each)

<Gameplay Mechanic #1>

<Gameplay Mechanic #2>

<Gameplay Mechanic #3>

<Gameplay Mechanic #4>

Detailed Gameplay Mechanics

- <Core Gameplay Mechanic #1>
 - <Details>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
 - <How it works>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
- <Core Gameplay Mechanic #2>
 - <Details>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
 - <How it works>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
- <Core Gameplay Mechanic #3>
 - <Details>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
 - <How it works>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
- <Core Gameplay Mechanic #4>
 - <Details>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/
 - <How it works>
 - /Describe in 2 Paragraphs or less/

Wireframes

Wireframes are detailed interface maps and outlined charts that will allow a web builder, games designer, or mobile app builder, for example, to create the structural elements of a build, prior to final assets and graphics being put in place. They can themselves be elements in the storyboard above, but are likely to have much more detail and so are best documented separately. The wireframe will usually have pixel coordinates and block references to different sections of the app, game scene or site. For early planning documents, these wireframes are not as important as 'look & feel' mockup designs, but are useful nonetheless to develop thinking around functionality.

1/2.—.1.page.for.each.interface

Style guide, colour and font specs

Precise details of colour palettes, graphics and story boards are very important in implementing the design aesthetic. This section will detail a range of colours unique to the visual design, and list requirements such as RGB values, textures, font usage and other quantifiable design features. It will also cover at a high level the styles of artwork and photography and include key examples.

2.pages

Media design styles

As in linear production, emphasis on visual components often prevails. With full visual interfaces having been covered in earlier sections, this is the place to demonstrate other media elements. Audio & musical styles can be described (even linked to), along with examples of moving title sequences for trailers or short videos, spoken word, and many other media assets. This section should be a textual overview of the style of all media elements to provide cohesion with other visual elements.

1.page.

Full assets list

Flowing on from previous sections, this provides a hierarchical list of assets to be produced, and will aid production planning if everyone is clear on what needs to be created vs bought in. During early planning stages, this will be high level, but as production nears will start to become a deep hierarchy of assets to create. It will focus on media assets that have a design need, rather than a pragmatic catch-all asset production list.

1–2.pages.

TECHNOLOGY SPECIFICATION

This section is linked to the scoping and business requirements sections, and is a perspective on why certain platforms, devices or systems are being used. Why, for example, is a certain mobile device and operating system being used over another? Is it due to user need? Other aspects covered here are directly connected to the platforms identified in the Functional specification chapter, and highlight how differing platforms provide the ability to be connected, share assets or extend the experience seamlessly. This section refers to technical platform environments at a high level, of which some are detailed below:

- 2D PC web: traditional browser-based websites that can include Flash, HTML5, or simple rich media elements
- 3D PC: isometric or **full 3D application** or browser based game-like engines
- **Mobile (generic):** well connected handset sized smart-phones but also SMS only based handsets
- **Tablets (generic): larger-screen portable, connected devices**
- Connected TV & set top box: specific hardware connected to or integrated in large-screen TVs or cinema screens that effectively combine TV content and the web
- Specialised consoles: such as large games platforms, media boxes or **handheld games devices**
- **Augmented reality: technologies allowing layering of digital content over the real world; primarily marker or location-based**
- **The real world: physical space**
- TV sets
- Cinema screens

This is tablet and phone based, while designed to operate in the real world.

In Tablet mode,

In Phone mode,

In Augmented reality mode,

System architecture

One or two very detailed charts will show how platforms, and the channels within them, are interconnected, and how content and data flows around this technical ecosystem. It will need some detailed descriptive text alongside, and in effect is the technical version of the User journey scenarios, the User journey chart and Storyboard – so needs to reference or be referenced from those.

Approximately 3 pages

Underlying magic in the technology

Although any service should not rely on new technology or a new use of existing technology, it is often the case that multi-platform services do feature something that makes the service special and different. So this section will highlight aspects of the project that make it stand out and may have marketing potential.

1/2.page

Service build infrastructure

This covers the multi-platform engines on which the service is delivered, and will refer to a hierarchical technical ecosystem for very complex services. It will make technical statements such as “the casual web game will be built in Flash CS5, AS3”, or “the webisodes will run on a bespoke Java engine built for all web browsers”. The hierarchy may refer to elements such as:

- Operating systems: Android, IOS, Windows, Linux, Mac OS, etc
- Coding environments: Java, Objective C, Action Script 3, HTML5, etc
- Open source engines: Wordpress, Drupal, Joomla, etc
- Client software/players/tools: Flash, Unity, OpenTV, Unreal, Crytek, etc
- Existing web services: Ning, Facebook, YouTube, Flickr, Twitter, etc
- Media formats: MP4, MP3, .exe, .gif etc

Approximately 3 pages

Device methodology

Multi-platform devices require their own thinking, and the range of smartphones/tablets or connected TVs, for example, is constantly evolving. This section will therefore detail key hardware choices and deployment issues. It will identify any cross-platform considerations (eg: PS3 vs Xbox vs Wii, or iPhone vs iPad vs iTouch), and also list specific models or versions of hardware that the service is focused on.

1.page.

User management

A critical aspect of all multi-platform services is managing users in real time or asynchronously. Technically this section will define how user data collected from subscription and during the use of the service will be managed. There may be requirements to build bespoke systems that can both collect usage data and also communicate back to users automatically, and such requirements will be defined at high level here with specific examples of features that will be needed. This may be part of a broader CMS (Content Management System) or CPMS (Content Production Management System) definition.

1–2.pages

Content management, back-end and server

This describes how the complexity of many media assets will be managed and fed in and out of the service, as well as backups, managing user-generated content, and the server requirements. Some complex, real-time multi-platform services will require bespoke 'control dashboards' and associated back-ends to be built from scratch to manage the flow of content and users; these will be described here. The section will also detail, for example, the pros and cons of using third party hosting, content management software, or building something specific for this service. Overall it is a description of everything back-end that will glue the whole project together.

2–3.pages

Coding and builds

This section will detail any specific elements (eg, game engines, application interfaces, subscription systems, data management, etc) that need to be built from the ground up or modified from existing engines. It will detail both the coding environments, a sense of where that resource is, and a likely time estimate for development.

1.page

Technical Assets

<What assets will you need to make>

- 2D

- Textures
 - Environment Textures
- Logos
- HUD
- Other

- 3D

- Characters List
 - Character #1
 - Character #2
 - Character #3
 - etc.
- Environmental Art Lists
 - Example #1
 - Example #2
 - Example #3
 - etc.

- Sound

- Sound List (Ambient)
 - Outside
 - Level 1
 - Level 2
 - Level 3
 - etc.
 - Inside
 - Level 1
 - Level 2
 - Level 3
 - etc.
- Sound List (Player)
 - Character Movement Sound List
 - Example 1

- Example 2
- etc.
- Character Hit / Collision Sound list
- Example 1
- Example 2
- etc.
- Character on Injured / Death sound list
 - Example 1
 - Example 2
 - etc.
- Code**
 - Character Scripts (Player Pawn/Player Controller)
 - Ambient Scripts (Runs in the background)
 - Example
- NPC Scripts
 - Example
 - etc.
- Animation**
 - Environment Animations
 - Example
 - etc.
 - Character Animations
 - Player
- Example
- etc.
- NPC
 - Example
 - etc.

Quality assurance testing

Often referred to as just 'QA', this section will cover how all elements of the service will be tested during development. For specific engine builds through to connectivity with third party services, it will provide an overview of the methodology rather than being a detailed guide, but will include timescales for testing and fully functional builds.

1/2.–.2.pages

BUSINESS & MARKETING

Goals

This section should cover three goals of the service, encapsulating the overall reason for creating it:

A.. What. do. you. want. to. achieve. from. the. perspective. of. the. user. through. the.service?.For.example:

- Stimulate community-based storytelling
- Get the audience to be highly active during a live broadcast
- Create deeper engagement between scheduled events
- Get the audience to become active outside the home
- Stimulate massive community created content contribution
- Make the service highly personalised
- Develop a powerful tease service to a must-view linear property

B..What.are.the.goals.from.the.perspective.of.the.creative.team?.For.example:

- Reach a younger or older demographic
- Experiment with never before tried multi-platform concepts
- Improve the skills of the team
- Raise awareness of issues, social good or another media property
- Design a service that lasts two years and longer
- Build a strong female or male viewership

- Build a loyal local and/or international community for your property
- Increase the overall audience

C.. What.is.the.economic.goal.or.model?

- Commercial: revenue generation through mature digital business models
- Marketing: at cost, promotional/marketing/advertising of another product or property
- Social good: at cost, awareness and issue raising or cultural, educational and/or artistic statements
- Experimental: a new type of project designed to push boundaries, with the freedom to fail and lose money but learn from

1.page

Success indicators

How will the stated goals be measured, and from those results how will you decide if the service has been successful? The KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) and ROI (Return On Investment) are traditional ways to measure success, but from a story perspective there may be other engagement metrics you are building into your service/s.

1-2.pages

User need

This is a short high-level section covering the key question of why your service will be noticed and used. A simple user-needs analysis will highlight gaps in the market, weak competition, or just a strongly 'needed' utility-like service.

1.paragraph

Target audience and marketing

This section will cover two key areas: Who will use the service, and how will you attract them to it? It will include a demographic and psychographic breakdown of your user/audience, listing competing services or examples of similar services, quoting numbers. It will be a well researched comparative analysis and most likely use some bespoke research you have completed for the project. A logical progression from this is how you will attract and market to them so they are aware your service exists. A range of techniques from traditional to social media marketing needs to be covered here, and estimates of numbers over time should be front and centre. Another key element that needs to be covered is the community strategy for the service, confirming what will be put in place to grow a community of interest as well as a loyal subscriber base.

2–4.pages.

Business models

This provides an overview of how the budget will be raised or revenue generated. For many multi-platform services there will be a mix of business models, so this section will detail primary and secondary models, which may include the following:

- Sponsorship (commercial or funded by agency)
- Advertising: text based or rich media advertising

(surround or product placement)

- Subscription (to use the service): part of the freemium/premium model
- Transaction: direct sales of product, pay per use or premium or extended elements
- Affiliate marketing: money for connecting with like services
- Virtual currency: taking a percentage of exchanges for virtual currency from real world money
- Direct sales of the multi-platform 'format itself' to third parties
- Sales to market intelligence of anonymous user data
- Peer-to-peer: taking a percentage of user-to-user fees in your project's 'market', such as virtual goods exchanges or embedded online auctions
- Sales of product placement spots
- Donations to parts of whole elements of the service

This section need not detail likely revenues, but rather estimate likely numbers, and convince the reader that the models will genuinely work.

1-2.pages

Projections, budgeting and timelines

This section will detail all the important costs and/or likely revenues and/or profits from the service. It should include a spreadsheet listing how much the service will cost to build, and this may develop in granularity as the service planning moves forward. It will be linked to the schedule of production, and should break down potential budget spend at each milestone. Due to the nature of a complex production, the spreadsheet should also break down according to platform, so further down the track decisions can be made on deployment. Finally, a project management Gantt chart will minutely detail timelines linked to budget requirements. The projections will be a realistic assessment of likely revenues generated, including whether and when the project will break even and move into profit.

2–5.pages

Production team

It may be worth breaking this in to two sections. The first should be a full breakdown of the multi-disciplinary team related to this specific project, listing their individual multi-platform and/or transmedia roles and responsibilities. The second section provides biographical backgrounds on each of the team with head shots if possible. A complex project will require the key roles of transmedia producer/s, writer/s, designer/s, technical lead, system architect, programmers, business managers, marketing and so on to a maximum of say ten project leads.

1/2.–1.page.per.team.member

Status and next steps

Every complex multi-platform project will go through layers of parallel project development. This section should clearly list the status of the overall project across key areas including funding, development, investment, pre/post production, current production and delivery goals and date targets. It should also list progress for each of the main platforms individually, as there is likely to be significant staggering of development on each.

1–2.pages

Copyright, IP & licensing

This section will cover a range of intellectual property and other issues such as who owns the intellectual property (IP) in the story and created content, whether partners are taking overall shares as part of developing aspects of the service or investment, whether there is licensing interest in the service from third parties, and so on. It should highlight significant business conditions under which the project is operating.

1–3.pages

Summary and calls to action

Often the business and marketing plan is a natural finish to the production and/ or planning bible from a production document perspective. As a presentation or submission document it is worth re-iterating the opening tags: why the service is unique, and key story or service goals as a focused wrap outside of the business plan.

1–2.pages